

ARACHIS

ONLINE TRAINING

BISCUITS AND COOKIES PRACTICAL FORMULA

Beginner-Friendly Notes for Small-Scale Production

Plain Biscuits | Cookies | Baking Guide | Troubleshooting | Packaging Tips

Prepared for Arachis Students
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1. Introduction and Plain Biscuits Formula

Difference Between Biscuits and Cookies

Biscuits are usually firmer, drier, and crispier. They are good for tea, school snacks, and long shelf life. Cookies are richer because they use more fat and sugar. They can be soft, chewy, or crunchy depending on how they are baked.

Plain Biscuits Formula

Batch Size

This formula uses 1 kg flour and can produce about 1.5 kg to 1.7 kg finished biscuits, depending on thickness and moisture loss during baking.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
Cake flour or plain flour	1 kg	Main body of the biscuit
Margarine or baking fat	250 g	Makes biscuits soft inside and crisp after baking
Sugar	250 g	Sweetness and colour
Baking powder	20 g	Helps biscuits rise slightly
Salt	5 g	Balances sweetness
Milk powder	50 g	Improves taste, colour, and richness
Eggs	2 eggs	Binds the dough and improves texture
Vanilla essence	10 ml	Flavour
Water or milk	120-180 ml	Helps form dough

Equipment Needed

- Mixing bowl
- Measuring scale
- Measuring spoon or cup
- Rolling pin
- Biscuit cutter, knife, or cup
- Baking tray
- Oven
- Cooling rack or clean tray
- Packaging plastics or containers

2. Plain Biscuits: Mixing and Dough Preparation

Step-by-Step Method

- 1** Prepare the oven and baking tray: Preheat the oven to 170-180 deg C. Grease the baking tray lightly with margarine or oil. Do not use too much oil because the biscuit bottoms can become oily. Preheating is important because biscuits must enter a hot oven.
- 2** Mix the dry ingredients: In a clean bowl, add flour, baking powder, salt, and milk powder. Sieve them together if possible so the baking powder spreads evenly. This prevents some biscuits from rising too much while others remain flat.
- 3** Cream the margarine and sugar: In another bowl, mix margarine or baking fat with sugar until soft and creamy. This helps make the biscuits lighter and less hard.
- 4** Add eggs and flavour: Add the eggs one by one and mix well. Add vanilla essence and mix again. The mixture may look slightly loose after adding eggs; that is normal.
- 5** Add the flour mixture: Add the dry ingredients slowly in portions and mix gently until a rough dough starts to form. Do not overmix because overmixing can make biscuits tough.
- 6** Add water or milk gradually: Start with 120 ml. Add more only if needed until the dough becomes firm, smooth, easy to roll, and not sticky. If the dough is sticky, add a little flour. If it breaks apart, add a little water or milk.
- 7** Rest the dough: Cover and rest the dough for 15-20 minutes so the flour absorbs moisture properly. Do not rest the dough for too long in a hot place because the fat can melt and make the dough oily.
- 8** Roll the dough: Roll on a lightly floured surface. Use 4 mm for crispy biscuits, 5-6 mm for normal tea biscuits, and 7 mm for thicker softer biscuits. Roll evenly so all biscuits bake at the same time.
- 9** Cut the biscuits: Use a cutter, knife, cup, or bottle top. Place on a lightly greased tray and leave a small space between them. Prick with a fork if desired for a professional look and even baking.
- 10** Bake the biscuits: Put the tray into the preheated oven and bake until the biscuits are lightly golden and firm.

3. Plain Biscuits: Baking and Cooling

Baking Instructions for Biscuits

Item	Instruction
Oven temperature	Bake at 170-180 deg C. A good starting point is 175 deg C.
Baking time	Bake for 12-18 minutes depending on biscuit thickness, size, sugar level, and oven strength.
How to know biscuits are ready	The edges should be light golden brown, the bottom lightly browned, the top dry, and the biscuit firm when touched lightly. Do not wait for the whole biscuit to become dark brown. Biscuits continue to harden as they cool.
Important baking tips	If they brown too fast, reduce heat to 160-170 deg C. If they remain pale too long, increase slightly to 180 deg C. If the bottom burns, place the tray higher or reduce heat. If the top burns first, the oven is too hot.

Cooling

Remove the tray from the oven and leave the biscuits on the tray for 3-5 minutes. Freshly baked biscuits can break easily. Transfer to a cooling rack or clean tray and cool completely for 30-60 minutes before packing. Never pack warm biscuits because trapped steam makes them soft and can reduce shelf life.

Expected Result

- Light golden in colour
- Firm and crisp after cooling
- Slightly sweet
- Good for tea
- Suitable for small-scale selling

4. Cookies Formula and Mixing Method

Batch Size

This formula uses 1 kg flour and gives about 1.6 kg to 1.9 kg finished cookies, depending on extras such as raisins, chocolate chips, coconut, or nuts.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
Cake flour or plain flour	1 kg	Main body
Margarine or butter	400 g	Richness, softness, and spread
Sugar	350 g	Sweetness, colour, and texture
Baking powder	15 g	Light rise
Salt	5 g	Balances sweetness
Eggs	3 eggs	Binding and richness
Vanilla essence	10-15 ml	Flavour
Milk powder	50 g	Better taste and colour
Water or milk	50-100 ml	Only if dough is too dry
Chocolate chips, raisins, coconut, or nuts	100-200 g	Optional flavour additions

Step-by-Step Method

- 1 Prepare the oven and tray: Preheat to 170-180 deg C and grease the tray lightly. Leave enough space because cookies spread more than biscuits.
- 2 Mix dry ingredients: Combine flour, baking powder, salt, and milk powder. Sieve if possible.
- 3 Cream margarine and sugar: Beat until soft and creamy. This stage helps make cookies lighter and better textured.
- 4 Add eggs and vanilla: Add eggs one at a time and mix well after each egg. Then add vanilla essence.
- 5 Add the flour mixture: Mix gradually until a soft dough forms. Do not overmix because cookies can become tough.
- 6 Add liquid only if needed: Start with 50 ml if the dough is too dry. Cookie dough should be soft and slightly sticky, not runny.
- 7 Add optional ingredients: Fold in chocolate chips, raisins, coconut, crushed nuts, oats, lemon zest, or cocoa powder.
- 8 Shape the cookies: Place small balls of dough on the tray, flatten slightly, and leave 4-5 cm between cookies so they do not join during baking.

5. Cookies Baking Instructions

Item	Instruction
Temperature	Bake at 170-180 deg C, with 175 deg C as a good standard.
Time	Bake for 10-15 minutes. Cookies bake faster than biscuits because they are richer and softer.
How to know cookies are ready	Edges are golden brown, the top looks set and dry, the bottom is lightly browned, and the centre is still slightly soft. Cookies become firmer as they cool.
For soft cookies	Bake 10-12 minutes. Remove when the edges are lightly golden but the middle is still soft.
For crunchy cookies	Bake 13-15 minutes and leave in the switched-off oven for 3-5 minutes with the door slightly open.
For thick cookies	Shape thicker balls and bake at 170 deg C a little longer. This prevents the outside from burning before the inside is cooked.
For thin crispy cookies	Flatten more before baking and bake at 175-180 deg C until golden brown.

Cooling

Leave cookies on the tray for 5 minutes, then transfer to a cooling rack or clean tray. Cool completely for 30-60 minutes before packing. Fresh cookies are soft and can break easily, so handle carefully until cooled.

6. Variations and Troubleshooting

Common Flavour Variations

Variation	Ingredients to Add	Notes
Lemon biscuits or cookies	Lemon essence 10 ml; lemon zest 1-2 teaspoons optional	Gives a fresh tea-biscuit flavour
Coconut biscuits or cookies	Desiccated coconut 100-150 g	Reduce flour by about 50 g for a softer texture
Chocolate cookies	Cocoa powder 50-80 g	Reduce flour by the same amount of cocoa added
Ginger biscuits	Ginger powder 20-30 g; cinnamon powder 5 g optional	Bake slightly longer for a crunchy result
Raisin cookies	Raisins 100-200 g	Soak briefly in warm water, then drain before adding

Troubleshooting Guide

- Biscuits are too hard: Possible causes are too little fat, too much flour, too little liquid, overmixing, or baking too long. Solution: measure correctly and avoid overbaking.
- Biscuits are too soft after cooling: Causes include underbaking, packing while warm, too much liquid, or poor storage. Solution: bake properly, cool fully, and use airtight packaging.
- Cookies spread too much: Causes include too much fat, warm dough, too much sugar, or a hot tray. Solution: chill the dough for 15-30 minutes and do not place dough on a hot tray.
- Cookies do not spread: Causes include too much flour, too little fat, or dry dough. Solution: add a little milk or water and flatten slightly before baking.
- Bottom burns: Causes include high oven heat or the tray being too close to the lower heat. Solution: reduce temperature and use the middle shelf.
- Biscuits taste bitter: Usually caused by too much baking powder or poor mixing. Solution: measure correctly and sieve the dry ingredients.

7. Packaging, Shelf Life and Business Tips

Packaging Instructions for Selling

Make sure biscuits or cookies are completely cold before packing.

Pack size	Suitable for
50 g	School children and tuckshop sales
100 g	Small snack pack
250 g	Family pack
500 g	Bulk home pack
1 kg	Orders, shops, and events

Packaging Label

Use clear plastic packets, ziplock bags, containers, or branded packaging. A good label should show the product name, weight, ingredients, date made, best-before date, business name, and contact number.

Suggested Shelf Life

Product	Shelf Life
Plain biscuits	2-4 weeks
Crunchy cookies	2-3 weeks
Soft cookies	5-10 days

Store in a cool, dry place away from sunlight. Soft cookies have shorter shelf life because they contain more moisture.

Important Business Tips

- Start with simple flavours such as plain vanilla, coconut, ginger, chocolate, and raisin.
- Do small test batches before producing in bulk.
- Record your formula, baking time, oven temperature, and customer feedback.
- Maintain consistent quality and packaging for repeat customers.

End of Guide - Prepared for Arachis Students